

POLICY PAPER

Guidelines and Rubric

POLICY PAPER LENGTH & DEADLINE

Goal: Students are required to submit a policy paper that advocates for a change in Texas policy or the creation of an entirely new Texas policy.

- It should be 6 pages long with 1 title page (total 7 pages)
- It is due on **November 23 at 11:59pm via Turnitin on eLearning.**

POLICY PAPER SUBSTANTIVE REQUIREMENTS

- Cite at least one academic article (peer-reviewed journal)
- Cite at least one policy paper
- Cite at least one news article
- Use at least one visual representation of data (graph, bar, chart, etc.)
 - You are encouraged to use a graphic from another source, but must cite it.

POLICY PAPER ORGANIZATIONAL REQUIREMENTS

- **Executive Summary/Introduction:** Introduce the policy issue and its significance. Offer a concise summary of the key points in your paper and your recommendations. Clearly state your objective and the target audience.
- **Problem Statement:** Describe the policy issue in detail, including its causes, effects, and any existing challenges or gaps in the current policy framework.
- **Policy Options:** Present possible solutions to address the problem (at least one in addition to what you are recommending). Analyze the pros and cons of these approaches.
- **Recommendations/Implementation Strategies:** Based on your analysis, provide a clear and actionable recommendation. Explain how your recommendation should be implemented. Be sure to identify likely obstacles and how they could be overcome.
- **Conclusion:** Briefly summarize the main points of your paper and reiterate the importance of your recommendations.
- **References:** List any sources you used in your research. Use APSA or Chicago style citation.

FORMATTING GUIDELINES

- Times New Roman
- 12pt font
- Double space
- Default Margins
- Title Page: Name, Title, Class, and Date (1 page)
- Turnitin on eLearning
 - Email me by the deadline if you are experiencing difficulty with Turnitin. You will still eventually need to submit your paper through Turnitin.

GRADING RUBRIC

- Formatting (20%): Adherence to formatting and citation guidelines.
- Policy Issue and Analysis (20%): Is the issue being examined a policy issue? How well is the problem identified? Can it be solved? Is the recommendation or evaluation clear and well-explained? Are pros and cons of the proposal discussed?
- Use of Sources (20%): Does the paper cite an academic article, policy paper, and news article? Were these sources relevant? Are they used appropriately?
- Organization: (20%): Does the paper follow the organizational requirements?
- Quality of Writing (20%): Is the paper well-written? Are there spelling and grammatical errors? Is it thoughtful, creative, and concise?